

Escape room reflection

This was an interesting project. For this one, I took the role of writing the narrative for this one.

Establishing where the beginning and end were was the easy part. The game continues at the end of the last battle in the dungeon crawler. In the game, the player starts in a dream with his alternate self, where he confronts his alternate self about what he is and why he exists.

Throughout the game, the player solves puzzles and works with his teammates and the doctor's daughter, Luna, to advance and escape the alt world. While figuring out what the main story plot points were was easy, figuring out the dialogue was a difficult task. Because the puzzles take a while to complete. I waited until they were finished. When they were done. I realized that the puzzles were set up in a different order than what I thought they would be. So at the last minute, we had to rewrite some of the plot points to better fit the game.

For this, I created a new dialog system; the old one looked bad and was clearly done last-minute. What I wanted to do for this game is create a dialog system that can transition depending on where the player is in the game. For example, when the player solves a puzzle, a trigger will cause the dialogue of some characters to advance.

We have a lot of work to do when it comes to working as a team. There was a lot of confusion among team members when it came to narratives, room layouts, and puzzles. A good amount is my fault, to be honest. I waited until assets were created to clarify what was needed for the narrative. Leading to a lot of narrative elements being created at the last minute.

I will say this every time, and it will never happen, but I wish we could have started earlier. What we should do for the last game is establish the narrative early and work around it. We have all of the tech we need to create a great final game. We need to put the pieces together and focus.